

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



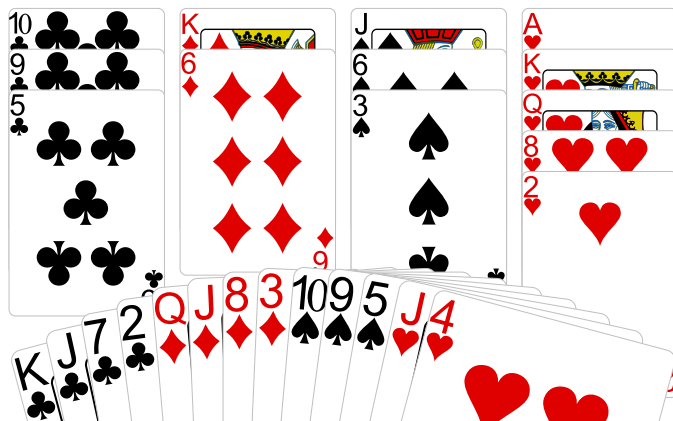
Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



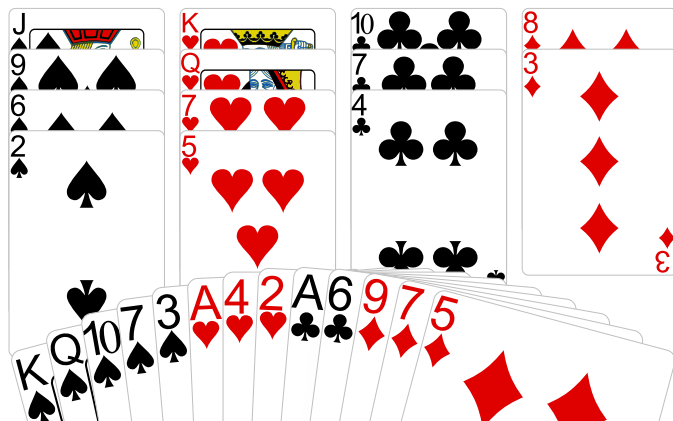
Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 4 Ctr: 2♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2♠
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 5 2
♥ K 9 3
♦ T 8 7 3
♣ K 5 3

16
7 6
11

♠ K Q T 8 4
♥ A 7
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q T 6



♠ A 9 6 3
♥ Q 6 4
♦ A 9 6 2
♣ J 7

♠ 7
♥ J T 8 5 2
♦ J 4
♣ A 9 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

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NORTH has 17 points and might open 1NT.
But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers

to open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist

on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3 ♠, which NORTH is strong

enough to raise to game.

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7
♥ T 6 4
♦ K Q T 9 6
♣ T 7 3

7
5 21
7

♠ J T 4 2
♥ K Q 8 2
♦ 7 5 3
♣ J 4



♠ Q 9 5 3
♥ 7 5 3
♦ 8 4
♣ K Q 9 6

♠ A K 6
♥ A J 9
♦ A J 2
♣ A 8 5 2

West

North

East
2NTSouth
Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

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EAST has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid.

Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

WEST adds her 6 points to EAST's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her

good



suit to be useful to WEST in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 4 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ 7 5
♣ A 8 6 3

13
10 9
8

♠ J 6 3
♥ A K Q 8 2
♦ K 6
♣ T 9 5



♠ T 9 5
♥ J 4
♦ Q J 8 3
♣ K J 7 2

♠ K 8 7
♥ T 5 3
♦ A T 9 4 2
♣ Q 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
All Pass			
1NT by South			

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NORTH has a solid 1



opening, 14 points and five trumps.

SOUTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least

11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

NORTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q T 7 3
♥ A 4 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6

9
13 6
12

♠ 8
♥ 8 6 3
♦ K J T 6
♣ K Q 9 8 3



♠ A 5 4
♥ J T 9
♦ A Q 4 2
♣ J 5 2

♠ J 9 6 2
♥ K Q 7 5
♦ 8 3
♣ T 7 4

West

1 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by West

North

Pass

East

2 ♠

South

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WEST has a normal 1 ♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

EAST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2 ♠,

passed by WEST.

EAST does not consider showing the



s,

first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have

the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 6 5
♥ J 6 4
♦ T 7
♣ A 6 4 2

15
5 2
18

♠ A 8 3
♥ A 7
♦ K J 9 6 4
♣ Q J 5



♠ K J 4
♥ K Q 9 2
♦ A Q 5
♣ K T 8

♠ Q 9 2
♥ T 8 5 3
♦ 8 3 2
♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			

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With balanced distribution and 16 points
NORTH should open 1NT rather than 1

♦

SOUTH's response is based on simple math.
He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that
NORTH has announced and

comes up with 33 points combined. This is
enough for a small slam, and since he has
balanced distribution

he bids 6NT.

Deal 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J T 9 6
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ A K 7

5
 20 7
 8

♠ 7 5 3
 ♥ 9 8
 ♦ K J T 9
 ♣ J 6 4 2



♠ A 8 2
 ♥ K J 5 4 3 2
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ T 3

♠ K 4
 ♥ Q T 6
 ♦ 8 5 3 2
 ♣ Q 9 8 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

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WEST is right at the maximum for a 1 ♠ opening bid - one more point and he would

have opened 2 ♣.

EAST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response.

She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

WEST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.